

a group of 100 children who were asked to evaluate what was a joke and what wasn't.

The kids classified 60 per cent of the JAPE jokes as jokes, 80 per cent of the human-made jokes as jokes, and 20 per cent of non-jokes as jokes. After adjusting for the vocabulary of the children at their age, there was no significant difference between the number of jokes classified as “jokes” for JAPE-made and human-made.

While JAPE was a successful early prototype of proving that machines could eventually develop a sense of humour, they still have a long way to go before artificial intelligence becomes aware enough to figure out the parameters for context on its own.

Why the human mind shouldn't be a model for AI

We've gone into much detail about how artificial intelligence systems use the human mind as a blueprint for creation and measurement. But how relevant is it when you actually think about it? Should the test of an artificial intelligence system really be its ability to mimic the human mind so closely that it fools another human mind, as is required by the Turing Test? There are, of course, several arguments on each side of the issue.

Consider that classic example given by Russell and Norvig where they say, “The quest for ‘artificial flight’ succeeded when the Wright brothers and others stopped imitating birds and learned about aerodynamics. Aeronautical engineering texts don't define the goal of their field as making ‘machines that fly so exactly like pigeons that they can fool even other pigeons’.”

Some food for thought. 